

Google Pixel 8 Pro

Exciting AI abilities, but priced incorrectly

We see some pretty exciting hardware upgrades on the Pixel 8 Pro this time around. Sadly, all of this comes at a pretty hefty price hike. The Pixel 8 Pro costs a whopping ₹1,06,999. That said, can the Pixel 8 Pro make a place for itself amongst competitors such as the Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra and iPhone 15 Pro? Let's find out.

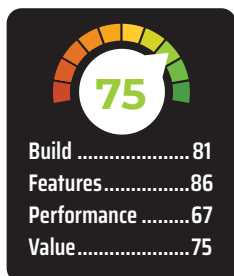
BUILD AND DESIGN

At first glance, the Pixel 8 Pro looks just about identical to the Pixel 7 Pro and 6 Pro. There are a couple of trivial changes if you inspect it closer though. The Pixel 8 Pro has replaced its predecessor's matte metallic visor with a glossy one; a downgrade, in my opinion. A layer of glass covers all three lenses – a much more unified design and a departure from the Pixels of the yesteryears. The thicker visor does cause some inconveniences when charging wirelessly or gaming. The frosted matte finish of the rear glass panel feels more premium than ever before and repels fingerprints like the plague. The bezels up front have been trimmed down considerably and look very close to symmetrical all the way around. The display is almost entirely flat, which bodes well for rejecting accidental touches. The phone is available in Obsidian and Bay colour variants in India. I do hope we get to see some major design changes next year.

DISPLAY

Let's move on to the display of the Pixel

₹1,06,999



8 Pro. We've got a new buzzword this time – Super Actua display – a new branding for its blindingly bright 2400-nit display. There's support for HDR10+ but sadly, no Dolby Vision support. The Always-On display is nice and minimalist, but there's no option for customisation as you get on the latest iPhones and Samsung flagships. The display is one of the brightest on the market. I tested the display's brightness levels using a LUX meter and I got an astoundingly high reading of 2,115 nits on Adaptive Brightness Mode under bright sunlight. This is the highest reading we've ever recorded in this test, which is commendable. So, the display is ludicrously bright, looks good at just about any angle, and is extremely sharp as well. The colours are very accurate and HDR content looks just fantastic. The Natural Mode display settings are excellently tuned.

CAMERAS

The Pixel 8 Pro sees some major improvements in the camera department. In daylight, the main sensor shoots excellent pictures with an uptick in sharpening compared to last year. The phone's colour profile leans towards the cooler side, which is the status quo for Pixel devices. But the photos look nice and saturated, have excellent detail retention and really good dynamic range. The 48 MP telephoto shooter spits out sharp images with good

detail. The ultrawide shooter, once again, excels. The detail is great and the photo's corners also have good sharpness levels. The dynamic range isn't as good as the main shooter, but the colours are nice and consistent. You can also shoot macro shots on the phone and the results are pretty detailed and sharp.

For portraits, the Pixel 8 Pro allows you to shoot these at 1.5x and 2x zoom levels. Weirdly enough, there's no 5x portrait option, which seems like a waste. The portraits good detailed in daylight; skin tones lean towards the reddish hue. What's disappointing is the edge detection. There are a lot of imperfections in the cutout, especially with the subject's hair or ears. Furthermore, the portrait shots look soft in low-light conditions. In typical Pixel fashion, the 8 Pro excels at clicking nighttime pictures. 5x and ultrawide low-light shots also have good levels of detail, but there is some noise at times. If you have ideal lighting, you can click a sharp and detailed selfie but if there's too much backlight, you will be sacrificing some sharpness. The main camera captures good-looking videos in the daytime, and the videos in low light have improved compared to the Pixel 7 Pro. It's still not close to the iPhone 15 video quality though.

PERFORMANCE

The Google Tensor G3 sits behind the wheels of the Pixel 8 Pro this year. The phone is noticeably behind competitors in synthetic benchmarks. It got a pretty decent score of 1 million+ in AnTuTu but the Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra and Apple iPhone 15 Pro leave those numbers in the dust. The same results repeat themselves in the GeekBench Multi-Core test and PC Mark Work and GPU benchmark tests such as 3D Mark Wild Life Extreme and GFXBench. In storage tests, the Sequential Read Speed is decent but the write speed is very low for a flagship. I also ran the CPU Throttling Test to check the phone's sustained performance under heavy stress and it performed miserably. I ran the benchmark for 15 minutes with 20 threads active and it throttled to 40 per cent of its peak performance. When